



FORTUNA ADMISSIONS
INSIDER'S TOP TIPS
FOR APPLYING TO
HEC PARIS

FORTUNA ADMISSIONS - INSIDER'S TOP TIPS FOR HEC PARIS

ABOUT THE SCHOOL

HEC Paris is one of the leading MBA programs in Europe, offering a 16-month program of study with two intakes: January and September. It occupies a unique space between the one-year programs like INSEAD and traditional two-year programs. Its 16-month program offers the intensity of an accelerated program while allowing students to pursue an internship or fieldwork project for one of the four-month segments. Many students have taken advantage of this option to gain entry to their post-MBA employers in cities like London, Paris, New York and Hong Kong. As part of the Paris Saclay Innovation Cluster, HEC Paris is able to attract some of the most innovative partners to work alongside students.

The program's reputation and international scope have grown in recent years – it's regularly ranked amongst the top three European business schools by the Financial Times, and 90 percent of students hail from outside France. It has also formed significant double degree partnerships with schools like Yale and NYU in the United States, LSE in the UK, and Chinese University of Hong Kong and Tsinghua University in Beijing, creating diverse global opportunities to experience two international schools with their full alumni networks and career services.

STRENGTHS AND SPECIALIZATIONS

Entrepreneurship, Marketing, Luxury, and Strategy

INCOMING CLASS

Number of Applicants: 2,111
Admissions Selectivity: 17.5%
Total Tuition: €69,620

MBA Class Size: 274
Yield: 18.24%

POST-MBA CAREERS

Sector: Consulting 24%; Financial Services 18%; Technology 17%; Healthcare 10%; CPG 8%
Top Recruiters: Amazon, McKinsey, Deloitte, Credit Suisse, Bain & Co., Google, L'Oréal
Avg. Base Salary: \$112,800 Employment in 3 months: 93%

MBA RANKINGS

	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019
BusinessWeek	12	–	15	14	5	7	19	–
Financial Times	11	10	12	12	13	10	10	23
Forbes	–	6	–	5	–	5	–	–
The Economist	2	2	2	3	6	8	11	–
US News	9	9	9	9	8	8	10	12

ADMISSIONS

Avg. Age: 30
Int'l Students: 92%

Avg. GMAT: 690
Female Students: 33%

Avg. GPA: 3.7

Deadlines for 2019-2020: *January or September intakes with rolling admissions.*

Jan 2020 intake: Aug. 16, '19
 Sept. 16, '19
 Oct. 15, '19
 Nov. 15, '19

Sept. 2020 intake: Aug. 16, '19
 Sept. 16, '19
 Oct. 15, '19
 Nov. 15, '19

Sources: HEC, BusinessWeek, Financial Times, Forbes, The Economist, US News, MBA50



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ESSAYS 2019-2020

- Essay One: Why are you applying to the HEC MBA Program now? What is the professional objective that will guide your career choice after your MBA, and how will the HEC MBA contribute to the achievement of this objective? (500 words MAX)
- Essay Two: What do you consider your most significant life achievement? (250 words)
- Essay Three: Leadership and ethics are inevitably intertwined in the business world. Describe a situation in which you have dealt with these issues and how they have influenced you. (250 words MAX)
- Essay Four: Imagine a life entirely different from the one you now lead, what would it be? (250 words)
- Essay Five: What monument or site would you advise a first-time visitor to your country or city to discover, and why? (250 words)

Insider Tips on the HEC Essays & Interview Presentation

By Brendan Kramp

Brendan served as the UK Director of Development for INSEAD and earned an MBA from HEC with a semester spent at NYU Stern. In addition to his MBA, Brendan holds a Masters in writing.

In terms of tackling HEC's five required essays, the key to standing out is to be creative and authentic. HEC asks unique questions in its essays, and it's important to make sure you answer all parts of the question. Think about what each question is really trying to learn about you, and how your answer makes you unique amongst other candidates.

When you answer the question about why you are applying for an MBA from HEC now, think about why this is the exact time that you need to earn an MBA in your career trajectory, and explain the rationale and how you came to that decision. What will an MBA at this point enable you to do, and why is HEC the program that makes the most sense for you? Make sure you articulate how the HEC program is different, and how that difference fits specifically with your own career plans and goals.

The question that asks about your most significant life achievement should let you to reflect on the biggest and most important things that have happened in all of your life – not just your career. It may be an example of something in which you doggedly persevered and finally succeeded in achieving. It may be reaching a personal best, a first-time experience, or a change in how you did something. What makes the best essay is not how big or important the achievement is compared to others, but how well you describe the why and how it is important to you, and your ability to convey that sense of importance to the admissions committee.

The essay that asks you to imagine an entirely different life than your current life is an opportunity to show both creative and analytical thinking. Imagine someone who is currently a banker in Hong Kong, for instance, and how a completely different life would be to become a farmer in the American Midwest. This would be a very different life, but the banker's character and skills/natural abilities would be similar – so what would a numbers-oriented, fast thinking individual contribute to farming, crop yields, markets and the like? That makes for a very interesting essay and shows how you think about yourself and the world.



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Tip #1 – Articulate an informed, global vision for your future.

Focus on how HEC's international scope, deep academic rigor and program structure, and access to a worldwide network fits with your goals and aspirations. HEC looks for academic performance and solid GMAT scores (2018 average of 718), in addition to ambitious career aspirations and backgrounds. You'll also want to think about what differentiates you from your peers. Articulate your uniqueness strongly in your application, along with how a global vision for your future will both benefit from and contribute to the alumni network of HEC.

Tip #2 – Know how HEC is unique.

HEC is different than many of its European counterparts because, like many US schools, the MBA program runs alongside a larger population of college-aged students studying business for a Masters in Management at the Grande Ecole. The HEC Grande Ecole is one of the top-rated programs in the continent, which is tremendous benefit to the MBA. For one, many professors teach in both the MBA and Grande Ecole, in addition to attracting to campus top speakers, recruiters and more. HEC has also distinguished itself by organizing the yearly MBA Tournament (MBAT), a months-long, class-wide project that involves volunteers, committees, gathering resources, teams and more. It's one of the features and bonding exercises that make the HEC MBA unique, and a real hands-on learning experience.

In terms of translating this to your essays and interviews, it's advantageous to tie your interests and plans to people or companies that demonstrate HEC's impact in the world. It can work well in your application to mention a few HEC alumni who have risen to leadership positions at the kinds of company or organizations that appeal to you. Do reach out to any local HEC alumni in your area working at different companies to glean firsthand insights on the program and what they thought about it – mentioning how you learned more about HEC directly from alumni gives you both perspective and an authentic edge when you write about some of the program aspects that appeal to you most.

Tip #3 – How does international fit in your career goals?

HEC has become a very international MBA program, and global experience is important and a real differentiator for candidates coming to the program. If you have lived or worked outside your own home country, think about what you learned inter-culturally and how that influenced you both as a person and as a professional. If you have not left your own country but have interacted with global teams, clients, service providers or vendors, think about one-to-two examples that are the most prominent and how you learned to work with people across different cultures, backgrounds and languages. How did you adapt your own style of working and outlook in order to achieve mutual success? This can be very powerful as part of your application. While experience traveling to other countries for vacation or short stints is valuable, be careful about listing a series of places you have visited like an itinerary. HEC is looking for what you learn from international exposure, how you changed, and how that is relates to your career and life objectives. It is always most powerful to use a specific example such as someone you met or an experience you had that changed the way you relate to the world and yourself.



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#4 – The interview presentation

HEC asks candidates who are invited to interview to make a short 10-minute presentation on a subject of their choice. This is an opportunity to showcase your composure and clarity of thought, ability to deliver a coherent argument or explanation, and to express both creativity and passion in your presentation. It does not have to relate to your job or career – in fact some of the best presentations don't – but it should be a subject that is relevant to you, and that you can communicate well to the interviewer. It's also important that you keep your presentation short – five or six slides should be plenty, including the introductory slide. What you want to do in 10 short minutes is impress a concept or new way of thinking to your interviewer and show how you have come to a specific conclusion or observation. Keep it engaging and interesting, too – the more memorable, the better.

Tip #5 – Connect your narrative and career vision to HEC's values.

While schools are looking for certain key competencies and achievements from candidates, it goes beyond your ability to get in and do well in the program. Every school wants candidates who will contribute to the school in the long run through your work, career progression, future leadership positions, involvement and more. You are selling your future vision as much as your current skills, GMAT scores, and accomplishments, so it's essential to know how your career goals intersect with the school's values and link them across your narrative about your reasons for pursuing the MBA. Think about how your life and career will look if everything goes the way you plan, and how that will also be of value to the school. Do you plan on starting your own company one day? Do you want to lead change in the way we source energy? Do you have a passion for using technology to solve a previously intractable problem? All of these are great stories about your future, and they become even better when you tie them to the specific characteristics of the school and how the program will help you get to that goal. This is also something that the school will enjoy highlighting when you get there, demonstrating the life-long value and impact that an MBA from HEC can make.

More about Fortuna Admissions:

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit [FortunaAdmissions.com](https://www.FortunaAdmissions.com)

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

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